

CHRISTOPHER WEEMS

Senior communications professional | Writing, Editing, Research Communication
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SUMMARY

Senior communications professional, writer, editor, and research storyteller with 20+ years of experience translating complex technical, academic, engineering, computing, finance, and policy-focused information into clear narratives for public, internal, executive, and specialist audiences. Experienced in editorial strategy, journalism, public relations, digital content, SEO, social media, web publishing, AI-assisted writing workflows, prompt refinement, and quality assurance. Known for sharp editorial judgment, AP-style discipline, fast subject-matter learning, and the ability to turn expert interviews and technical material into accessible, accurate, audience-centered stories.

EXPERIENCE

Georgia Tech Research Institute – Writer/Editor – Atlanta, GA

2021 – Present

- Write, edit, and refine communications for a major applied research organization, producing articles, press releases, web copy, internal communications, social media posts, podcast-related content, event recaps, executive messages, and research-focused features.
- Translate complex research and technical material in defense, national security, cybersecurity, artificial intelligence, hypersonics, computing, engineering, and applied science into clear narratives for employees, sponsors, partners, recruits, and public audiences.
- Interview researchers, executives, technical staff, and program leaders to identify compelling angles, clarify specialized concepts, and shape accurate, accessible stories that support organizational reputation and outreach goals.
- Edit Communications Department publications for grammar, accuracy, tone, structure, consistency, readability, and alignment with institutional voice across internal and external platforms.
- Lead or support social media strategy and daily posting for GTRI channels, contributing to a 14% increase in audience engagement and supporting a LinkedIn presence of more than 40,000 followers.
- Support website maintenance, content updates, SEO-minded web writing, engagement analytics, and podcast distribution, helping expand digital outreach and strengthen GTRI's podcast and multimedia content presence.
- Apply AI tools thoughtfully in the editorial process to brainstorm story angles, refine structure, test language, improve efficiency, and preserve the human judgment, factual accuracy, and organizational nuance required for professional communications.
- Coordinate with communications colleagues, researchers, leadership, and stakeholders to deliver timely, polished content under deadline pressure while handling multiple concurrent priorities.

Georgia Sentinel News/SAVANT Media – Editorial Consultant – Atlanta, GA

2019 – 2021

- Developed feature articles, social media content, marketing copy, and multimedia support materials to strengthen brand presence, reader engagement, and audience development.
- Provided editorial guidance on story structure, tone, headlines, copy flow, and publication readiness across web, print, and social channels.
- Assisted with web and print design tasks, helping maintain a cohesive editorial identity across digital and traditional formats.
- Supported the company's transition into video documentary production by helping shape content direction, editorial standards, and audience-facing messaging.

ASHRAE – Associate Editor – Atlanta, GA

2003 – 2019

- Edited highly technical content for ASHRAE Journal, Insights, and High Performing Buildings magazines, helping present engineering, building science, sustainability, standards, and industry research to professional and non-specialist audiences.
- Worked with engineers, researchers, authors, committees, and internal stakeholders to improve clarity, technical accuracy, narrative flow, style consistency, and reader accessibility.
- Wrote, edited, proofread, and packaged print and digital content under recurring production deadlines, maintaining editorial quality across multiple publication schedules.

- Designed and laid out regular publications and special issues, balancing editorial priorities, visual presentation, production constraints, and timely release requirements.
- Produced and optimized HTML, CSS, CMS-based newsletters, and web pages, supporting digital readership, discoverability, and SEO performance.

PRIMEDIA / Trusts & Estates Magazine – Associate Editor – Atlanta, GA

2000 – 2002

- Edited, wrote, proofread, and managed content layout for a B2B magazine serving wealth management, estate planning, tax, and legal professionals.
- Performed writing, editing, production, and website management functions for a lean editorial staff, demonstrating versatility across print and digital publishing roles.
- Launched cross-promotional initiatives for print and digital products, improving content visibility and increasing engagement across formats.

SKILLS

Writing, Editing, and Proofreading: Articles, press releases, web copy, newsletters, internal communications, executive messaging, features, profiles, scripts, podcast recaps, headlines, captions, and social media copy.

Research Communication: Translate academic, technical, defense, cybersecurity, engineering, computing, AI, sustainability, finance, and B2B subject matter for mainstream, stakeholder, and organizational audiences.

Editorial Strategy and Story Development: Identify news hooks, develop story angles, structure narratives, interview subject-matter experts, and align content with institutional priorities and audience needs.

AI and Content Quality: Evaluate AI-generated text for grammar, structure, tone, consistency, ambiguity, accuracy, and usefulness; develop and refine prompts that encode human editorial judgment.

Digital Content and Analytics: CMS publishing, HTML, CSS, SEO, responsive web content, newsletter production, web maintenance, social media management, engagement tracking, and content performance reporting.

Project and Client Management: Manage multiple deadlines, work independently, support virtual and cross-functional teams, apply style guidelines consistently, and provide clear, actionable editorial feedback.

EDUCATION

Emory University, Atlanta, GA

Bachelor of Arts, economics; Bachelor of Arts, English; Dean's List

Harvard University Extension School, Cambridge, MA

Graduate-level coursework in Sustainability and the Environment

Continuing Professional Development

Courses through Lynda.com, Udemy, Coursera, and KSU Continuing Education; ongoing self-directed development in writing, editing, web publishing, AI tools, and digital communications.